

ΠΡΟΝΟΜΙΚΕΣ ΟΔΗΓΙΕΣ

ΥΠΟΥΡΓΕΙΟ ΕΞΩΤΕΡΙΚΩΝ
ΕΛΛΗΝΙΚΗ ΔΗΜΟΚΡΑΤΙΑ

MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS
HELLENIC REPUBLIC

PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS



ΕΛΛΗΝΙΚΗ ΔΗΜΟΚΡΑΤΙΑ
ΥΠΟΥΡΓΕΙΟ ΕΞΩΤΕΡΙΚΩΝ



HELLENIC REPUBLIC
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Privileged Instructions

Fundamental Principle:

- The integration of the Turkish-held areas of Cyprus into the Republic of Cyprus

Desired End States:

- A bicommunal nation with a strong federal government, engendered with the freedoms encapsulated in the European Union community of nations; with primary consideration given, but not limited to, Freedom of Movement and Freedom of Settlement.
- The codification of a single nation within which reside peoples freely invested in a single Cypriot personality and heritage.
- A federation with a strong central government, fully representative of all Cypriots.
- The creation of a fully integrated Cyprus National Armed Forces to provide for the nation's security.
- The end of all agreements that binds the Republic of Cyprus to any other nation or organization undertaken without the full consent of its people.

Delegation Instructions

Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted via message to the office of the Foreign Minister.

GENERAL: The Republic of Cyprus exists as an internationally recognized nation. The division that occurred is the direct result of external actors that influenced the Turkish Cypriot community. Our historic ties, and relations with, the Greek Cypriot community are strengthened by common beliefs and traditions. Outside influences have created a rift that cannot be mended in its current state.

- The termination of the Turkish occupation and settlement, and the finding of a comprehensive, mutually acceptable, just and viable solution to the Cyprus problem are a top national priority of Greek foreign policy, with obvious significance for Greek-Turkish relations and for peace and stability in the wider region.
- Despite past disappointments and ongoing difficulties, the bicommunal talks – with the contribution of the UN Secretary General's Good Offices, remain the only method accepted by all interested parties for achieving an agreed settlement of the Cyprus problem.
- Greece firmly supports that an agreed solution should restore international legality, which is blatantly violated by the Turkish invasion and ongoing occupation of territory of the Republic of Cyprus, a sovereign and independent state that is a member of the United Nations and the European Union.
- We do not intervene in the negotiation of internal aspects of the Cyprus problem, for which the Cypriot government has exclusive competence.

NOTIONAL EXERCISE MATERIAL FOR EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES ONLY

- The full withdrawal of Turkish occupation forces and the termination of the anachronistic system of guarantees of 1960 are an integral part of an agreed, viable and comprehensive solution of the Cyprus problem.
- Greece's position is that the duration of the withdrawal of the occupation forces must be short, with a steady flow of the army's withdrawal and with a specific deadline for full withdrawal.
- Türkiye's demand regarding the securing of the EU's "four freedoms" in Cyprus is unrealistic and legally groundless.
- The Turkish Cypriot entity that has been self-declared in occupied Cyprus and that is recognized only by Turkey is illegal and has been condemned by the UN Security Council, which call on all states not to recognize it, not to facilitate it, and not to help it in any way.
- The exercise by the Republic of Cyprus of its sovereign rights in its exclusive economic zone are in no way linked to the process for the resolution of the Cyprus problem.

GOVERNANCE

The Turkish Cypriots have rejected inclusion into the already internationally recognized Republic of Cyprus. They state that any implementation of a settlement or peace agreement shall constitute a new nation. Their view that the unrecognized "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus" and the Greek Cypriots would start anew and that the Republic of Cyprus cease to exist. This "virgin birth" proposal would create an artificial state where the Turkish Cypriots are seeking to be internationally recognized and having right of self-determination to separate as its own nation if it desired.

The "virgin birth" proposal is a deal breaker. The Republic of Cyprus already exists and is recognized by the international community and accepted into the European Union. A new state would not enjoy these benefits. It makes better sense to incorporate the Turkish Cypriot community, and the lands that are occupied by Türkiye, into a united Republic of Cyprus as it existed before the invasion.

RED LINE: International recognition of the "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus" and any suggestion of a "virgin birth" proposal for a unified Cyprus.

POWER SHARING

Federal versus State: Turkish Cypriots insist on transferring many federal-level responsibilities and positions to the state-level. Areas such as airports, seaports, customs, banking, etc. are considered state-level in their eyes. Fears of a strong federal government with divided leadership will deadlock and not function and these areas will be affected. This may have been true in the 1960s but today we must build governmental structures that carry out the will of all the people of Cyprus, not just a small minority population. Appropriate safeguards should be designed to address concerns of the Turkish Cypriots, as well as other minority groups such as Armenians, Latins and Maronites. There is no need for duplicate institutions and structures at both the federal and state levels.

Advocate for a strong federal government system. Weaker communal states within the federal system are the only way to maintain governance. Clearer separation between federal and state institutions and structures will ensure efficient and effective government at all levels.

RED LINE: A confederation system where there is a weak federal government versus strong state governments.

The Federal Executive: The composition of a united government remains deadlocked over the composition of the executive branch. Turkish Cypriots appear to prefer a Senate-elected President and Vice-President and advocate for a rotating system. They desire that both offices rotate between communities every three years.

Greek Cypriots advocate for presidential elections where the President and Vice-President are on “one ticket” to represent a whole slate of principles. A direct popular vote for the office of the President is desired. But they would consider a Senate-elected Vice-President as an acceptable compromise in order to get agreement on a popular vote for President.

Rotating between communities for the presidency removes the power of the electorate and disenfranchises them. They would have no voice in determining the nation’s executive.

SECURITY AND GUARANTEES

The Treaty of Guarantee was the most egregious pact made and has no place as part of an independent Cyprus. Language in the treaty was used by Türkiye to justify their illegal invasion in 1974. The need for an outside nation to impose itself as a guarantor on the sovereign Republic of Cyprus ended with the passing of the old colonial era.

The Treaty of Alliance structured a common defense of the island based on the Guarantor Powers. The current forces on Cyprus must be removed as they were never emplaced as part of this treaty. We do not agree that the island should be demilitarized. With the only external threat, Türkiye, any demilitarization could once again threaten the Republic of Cyprus. Therefore, there is a need for a standing national army. It should be structured under the Treaty of Alliance having a 60:40 Greek Cypriot to Turkish Cypriot ratio with 1600 total soldiers.

We champion the UN proposal that these treaties be replaced by a new treaty between a united Republic of Cyprus along with us and Türkiye. The UN prescribes a new set of mechanisms to address inter-communal issues where the two communities cannot easily deal with them alone. Talks on this proposal should not include a military component except addressing terms regarding unexpected military attacks. Do not let the Turkish Cypriots insist on the “right of military intervention”. But if this point persists and becomes a deal breaker then advise the Greek Cypriots that they may offer consideration of this point but that it be limited to constituent state boundaries. We support the current UN Peacekeeping Force to remain in place until time allows for the nation to build its national army.

RED LINE: The right of military intervention by any outside state is unacceptable.

POPULATION

The island’s population has undergone significant shifts. Our position is that a full and complete census of the entire island, by an external non-partisan organization be conducted. There is no way to fully agree on population-driven political and social programs without the true number of actual Cypriots. Turkish immigrants and Turkish soldiers must be identified as to not skew the population figures and bias any true agreements.

We have to be cognizant of accurate numbers because of our European Union status. Resolving this issue has ramifications on the EU’s *acquis communautaire* regarding individual freedoms, specifically the right of Greek Cypriots to live, own businesses, buy property, and vote within the Turkish Cypriot community. The growing economic disparity between the communities is cause for concern by the Turkish Cypriots. They fear that when unification happens, they will be purchased out of land and businesses by Greek Cypriots. Any limitations on these freedoms can only be temporary, never permanent.

When it comes to residency requirements for local area elections there is room for compromise. For example, a Greek Cypriot moving to a Turkish community must maintain a legal residence for a minimum of 10-years before being granted the right to vote in local elections within that community. Otherwise, they must return to their prior residence to vote in their local elections.

None of the finer details can be worked out without a fully transparent census of the Turkish north. Once complete then specific discussions can occur. If there is resistance, offer that an entire island census can be conducted by a mutually agreed independent agency.

CONFIDENCE BUILDING MEASURES

Confidence building must be a continuous process along with the other issues listed above. Expect the leading advocates to be the United States and United Kingdom. We should be prepared to respond. Expect them to press both us and Türkiye on certain measures.

Direct Trade Regulation and Turkish EU Accession

In the Republic of Cyprus' accession into the European Union in 2004, the European Commission approved a Direct Trade Regulation (DTR) to allow Turkish Cypriots the privilege of direct export to EU member states at reduced customs rates. Greek Cypriot leaders eventually blocked implementation of the DTR, arguing that the regulation required consensus of all member states. They stated that by not using Greek Cypriot ports and payment of external EU custom and port duties that it legitimized the illegal state of the "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus". In response Türkiye refused to implement provisions in the Ankara Protocol it had signed in 2005. Türkiye was blocked from accession into the EU.

We have no wish to prevent Türkiye's accession into the EU. We disagree with Greek Cypriots actions to maintain blockage of Türkiye's accession. Türkiye's accession would only serve to benefit our economic situation. Additionally, it may pave the way for further normalization of relations between us. Press the Greek Cypriots to remove the blockage as a form of confidence building.

Support smaller steps towards easing the DTR and Ankara Protocol restrictions. A compromise with the Turkish Cypriots to allow Famagusta to open for trade under EU, or UN, supervision in exchange for Ankara implementing positions on the Ankara Protocol. This will allow some Greek Cypriot trade with Türkiye and help ease economic difficulties within the Turkish Cypriot community.

Varosha, Famagusta Port, and Ercan Airport

Turkish Cypriots hold Varosha as a bargaining chip for future settlement. The suburban coastal area was developed into one of the most attractive tourist locations in the Mediterranean prior to the Turkish invasion. It has fallen into disrepair, but Turkish Cypriots have slowly attempted to reopen the area for development since 2020. Offers for redevelopment, for Greek Cypriot owners of properties seized during the partitioning of our country, have been empty as the Turkish Cypriots demand continued control of the city. Thus, Greek Cypriots have rejected these offers.

Since 2020 nearly a half-million visitors visited Varosha. The North has begun developing commercial use of the area in defiance to the original owners of the properties. UNFICYP raised this issue to the Turkish Cypriot authorities, but the UN announced that the situation is unchanged.

Ercan Airport is located in the Turkish Cypriot area. Greek Cypriots refuse to recognize its existence as a viable port of entry into Cyprus. They have prevented nations from offering direct flights into the north. They demonstrated this against Azerbaijan in 2005 over a single flight from Baku. Only direct flights from Türkiye can land at Ercan. A possible solution to help ease tensions would be to place the airport under UN, or EU, control for operations to include EU entry and customs regulations and protocols.

Note: The United States Government does not recognize the "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus." Usage of the terms "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus" and "TRNC" in this exercise, being administered by the United States Army War College, is used for educational purposes only and does not reflect a contradiction to the United States Government official stance.